

INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE LT02

Unit 2 Place in literary texts

Mark scheme

January 2024

Version: 1.0 Final



Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

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Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

- 1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
- 2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
- 3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
- 4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
- 5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
- 6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
- 7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

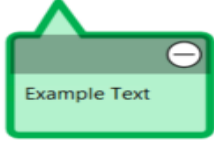
Using the mark bands

- 8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 7–9. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

- 9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
- 10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
- 11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Incorrect		Toolbar Tooltip: Incorrect		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
Not Relevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text - text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Lack Of Clarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
Partially Made Point		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The assessment objectives and their significance

- 12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 17 years old so we are judging their skills halfway through Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	- Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. - Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	- Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. - Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. - Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	- Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. - Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.
	AO2	- Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. - Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. - Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
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Joseph Conrad: *Heart of Darkness*

'In *Heart of Darkness*, African people are presented as much more than passive and powerless.'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Heart of Darkness* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- how African people are exploited by Kurtz and other colonisers, but also, perhaps, how the 'wilderness' takes a 'terrible vengeance' on him and others
- the resistance shown: eg the attack on the steamboat, the courageous defiance of the 'barbarous and superb woman'
- the jungle as a home that empowers African people
- the implication that those who are not victims of colonialism have strength and vitality: eg the 'black fellows' Marlow encounters on his sea voyage to the Congo
- the victims of enforced labour at the Outer Station
- how those at the Inner Station are far from passive: eg as shown by Marlow having to retreat on the steamboat.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the perspective of Marlow as narrator with an inevitably European bias
- how the setting can be seen as limited to only a small part of Africa: eg the area around the Congo river and the colonial stations
- details of descriptions of African people that may support or challenge the given view: figurative language, lexical choices
- dialogue that reveals colonial attitudes
- Marlow's responses to Kurtz's report for the International Society for the Suppression of Savage Customs
- the symbolism of the woman whom Marlow sees as representing the 'soul' of 'the whole sorrowful land'.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0 2

F. Scott Fitzgerald: *The Great Gatsby*

Consider the narrative significance of parties in *The Great Gatsby*.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Great Gatsby* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- decadence and self-indulgence of the Jazz Age
- Gatsby's attempts to impress and attract Daisy
- social attitudes and aspects of character as revealed by the parties and their settings
- superficial glamour
- attitudes towards women as shown at the parties: eg at Gatsby's house, at Tom and Myrtle's New York apartment, at the Plaza Hotel
- parties and sexual behaviour.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Nick Carraway's perspective: eg his comments and judgements
- the suite at the Plaza Hotel as the setting for the climactic confrontation between Tom and Gatsby, and Daisy's choice
- links between parties within the overall structure: eg development of relationships, comparisons, contrasts
- the irony of Fitzgerald's naming of guests who visited Gatsby's house
- description of both setting and people: eg lexical choices, imagery, syntax
- dialogue between party goers.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	3
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Kazuo Ishiguro: *The Remains of the Day*

Consider the narrative significance of Darlington Hall as a place of work.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Remains of the Day* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Darlington Hall as setting for the relationship between Stevens and Miss Kenton
- how Stevens' self-worth, his 'dignity', and his social attitudes are affected by his being a butler in a great English house
- how Stevens' position as an employee enables him to be present when Lord Darlington is involving himself in foreign affairs: eg the Banqueting Hall, smoking room, dining room
- how as employees Stevens and Miss Kenton are, in their different ways, constrained in their responses to the dismissal of the Jewish maids
- particular locations – what they signify and the effect they have on relationships: eg the butler's pantry ('a crucial office'), Stevens' father's room, the back corridor ('backbone to the staff's quarters'), Miss Kenton's parlour, the summer house
- Stevens' loyalty as an employee in a great house.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- structure: eg chronological pre-war narrative framed by Stevens' post-war journey
- other structural features in relation to narrative: eg the ending of the meetings over cocoa in Miss Kenton's parlour, Stevens' memory of standing outside her door
- the narrative perspective, Stevens as unreliable narrator, and, perhaps, the irony this entails
- the use of contrast: eg between servants' quarters and public areas, between the Hall in the present (servants' quarters 'dust sheeted') and the past
- the description of settings: eg lexical choices, figurative language, syntax
- dialogue concerning the work of the household: eg the disagreement over the Chinamen, between Stevens as butler and his employer or guests.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	4
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Aravind Adiga: *Last Man in Tower*

‘Mumbai is presented as no more than a greedy, threatening place.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Last Man in Tower* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Masterji’s death as a victim of greed and threat
- how Vishram Co-operative Housing Society shows initially that greed did not always prevail
- how Mumbai is growing and modernising, so change is inevitable
- how Tower A is in disrepair, has a ‘reasonable chance of collapse in the next monsoon’ and needs to be redeveloped
- how Masterji’s resistance arises out of emotional/sentimental attachment to his home
- the different motives of the Tower A residents – not always greed or fear
- how Shah’s offers can be seen as generous, and his use of persuasion as well as threats.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the third person perspective that gives an overview of Mumbai life with particular emphasis on Vishram Society as an example of commercial pressure
- the Confidence Group as an example of coercive business practice
- a chronological narrative in stages with gaps in time - showing intensifying pressure/growing threat with the murder of Masterji as the climax
- how the growing pressure to sell is presented through such things as dialogue, conflict, meetings between Shah and different Vishram residents
- the use of Masterji as a focus of resistance to ‘progress’ as it is represented by Dharmen Shah
- the use of symbolism: eg Ganesha (remover of obstacles) as emblem of Confidence Group, Shah’s statue of Nataraja (destruction and creation), banyan trees as unstoppable growth and ‘escutcheons of the House of Shah’
- dialogue, lexical choices, figurative language.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0 5

Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie: *Americanah*

‘She saw herself in a house from *The Cosby Show*, in a school with students holding notebooks miraculously free of wear and tear.’ (Chapter 8)

To what extent do you agree that Ifemelu’s time in America is presented as one of disillusionment?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Americanah* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Ifemelu’s idealisation of America before she leaves Nigeria
- the fact that Ifemelu does not experience racism until she arrives in America
- the difficulties she has with employment, epitomised perhaps by her encounter with the tennis coach and her subsequent depression
- how despite her problems she remains in America and eventually becomes successful
- the ultimate failure of her relationships with Curt and Blaine and her return to Obinze in Nigeria
- her return to Nigeria and how she believes that America is ‘a lie but you buy into it’.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- a retrospective, largely chronological narrative, but beginning in America with Ifemelu’s decision to return to Nigeria
- the third person narrative with Ifemelu as focaliser
- the recurrence of the braiding salon as a setting as the story progresses towards Ifemelu’s return
- hair and/or braiding as motifs
- Ifemelu’s blogs as a reflection of her American experiences
- dialogue: eg discussions in history seminar, conversations with employers, exchanges with lovers
- descriptions: lexical choices, figurative language.

Given that this is an open book exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	6
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Andrea Levy: *Small Island*

‘In contrast to Jamaica, England is presented as dreary and cheerless.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Small Island* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- England having much that is ‘dreary and cheerless’, but perhaps how this is relieved by humour and the growth of personal relationships
- how Jamaica has sunshine and in contrast a lively milieu, but perhaps is not without problems: eg hurricane, post-war shortages, unemployment
- Hortense’s reactions to squalid living conditions, but perhaps Gilbert’s stoicism and humour in relation to these and other aspects of life in England
- Gilbert’s return to Jamaica after the war and his comments
- the ways in which Queenie copes with problems: eg her upbeat responses
- Queenie’s neighbours and others as reflections of English society.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the before-and-after structure centred around post-war migration
- different perspectives presented through contrasting voices
- a narrative pattern that presents a story of difficulties overcome and which ends with some hope despite London being unchanged
- particular settings: eg Queenie’s recollections of her early life, difficult living conditions at the house in Nevern Street, Jamaica as recalled by Hortense and Gilbert
- dialogue presenting different attitudes and moods
- description: eg lexical choices, figurative language, motifs.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0 7

Thomas Hardy poetry selection

‘In his use of settings, Hardy seems to prefer the unpleasant to the pleasant, the ugly to the beautiful.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of the way Hardy uses locations? You should make detailed reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Hardy's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- unrelieved gloom or loss: eg ‘At a Lunar Eclipse’, ‘Neutral Tones’, ‘At an Inn’, ‘The Convergence of the Twain’
- the beauty of nature but, perhaps, also grief: eg ‘After a Journey’, ‘Beeny Cliff’
- pleasant (at least) memories of places: eg ‘At Castle Boterel’, ‘Places’
- the setting of ‘The Darkling Thrush’ being ‘ugly’ or having a harsh beauty, with a mood that is not entirely unrelieved
- the ‘pleasant’ setting of ‘To an Unborn Pauper Child’ within a troubled world
- sardonic humour in ‘Channel Firing’.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- structural shifts between present and past
- narrative patterns as indicated by such things as discourse markers, repetition, rhetorical questions and stanza divisions
- use of contrast or comparison between place and the mood or attitude of the persona
- use of direct address: eg to beloved, to former lover, to reader, to an unborn child, to the earth
- lexical choices, figurative language
- metre, rhyme and other prosodic features.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	8
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William Wordsworth poetry selection

‘There is much more to Wordsworth’s poetry than simple enjoyment of the natural world.’

Consider the significance of this view. You should make detailed reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as ‘significance’ relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Wordsworth’s poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- various concerns with, responses to and attitudes towards the natural world: eg ‘Tintern Abbey’, ‘Nutting’, ‘Elegiac Stanzas’
- ‘Michael’ as a tragic narrative
- ‘Composed upon Westminster Bridge’ and ‘Daffodils’ which may, perhaps, be enjoyed simply
- Wordsworth’s central interest being humanity
- poetry that informs, instructs or guides rather than being for ‘simple enjoyment’ alone
- the idea that we ‘murder to dissect’ and that enjoyment should be foremost.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- aspects of structure and the ways in which complex or numinous ideas are developed: eg the different stages in ‘Nutting’ as the narrator’s responses change
- the personal narrative of ‘Tintern Abbey’ and the ways in which it incorporates developing ideas and states of mind
- characterisation in ‘Michael’: eg through description, speech, action
- point of view: eg in relation to the natural world, to an addressee within the poem, in relation to the reader
- lexical choices, figurative language
- metre, verse form, stanza forms.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the poems should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument, here related to the poetic presentation of place
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	9
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Robert Frost poetry selection

‘Life is always presented as little more than a struggle to survive in a hostile environment.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of Frost’s poetry? You should make detailed reference to ‘The Black Cottage’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Frost’s poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the lonely, troubled life of the main subject of the minister’s story in ‘The Black Cottage’
- how the woman had principles and attitudes that show more than ‘a struggle to survive’, and how the minister believes in her influence beyond her isolated existence
- the death of the boy at his work in ‘Out, Out – ‘
- the desire to escape, at least temporarily, from life and its difficulties, but also, perhaps, some pleasure or satisfaction: eg ‘Stopping by Woods...’, ‘Birches’, ‘After Apple Picking’
- how natural phenomena offer beauty, invite introspection, provoke thought: eg ‘An Unstamped Letter...’, ‘Upon Looking up by Chance...’
- coping with making choices in ‘The Road Not Taken’.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the narrative structure of ‘The Black Cottage’: eg the ways in which it is shared by two narrators, its retrospective and historical perspective
- structural features: eg use of discourse markers, questions, repetition, verbal patterns
- point of view: eg in relation to audience (explicit or implicit), use of first person or third person
- symbolism: eg the black cottage as far as it represents a life lived, the ladder in ‘After Apple Picking’, coalescing stars in ‘An Unstamped Letter...’, snow in ‘Desert Places’
- the use of verse forms: eg long, single stanzas or four or five line stanzas
- metre, rhyme, speech rhythms and other features of prosody.

Given that this is an open book exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

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Seamus Heaney poetry selection

‘Heaney’s locations are places of death and darkness.’

To what extent do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to ‘Mid-Term Break’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Heaney’s poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- school and home in ‘Mid-Term Break’
- the graves of the bog people and, perhaps, how they reflect much more recent events
- how even where ‘death and darkness’ feature there is more: eg personal loss, political comment, sympathy with victims
- more distant places and how these give rise to historical and personal reflections: eg ‘North’, ‘Westering’
- places with life-affirming associations: eg ‘Anahorish’, ‘A New Song’, ‘Personal Helicon’
- resistance to oppressive forces: ‘Requiem for the Croppies’, ‘The Toome Road’.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- structure and sequence in ‘Mid-Term Break’: eg school setting, home, seeing dead brother next morning with a concluding expression of grief, and how these are related
- structural patterns of description, reflection and comment (explicit or implicit) and how they relate to each other: eg ‘Punishment’, ‘North’, ‘Personal Helicon’
- perspective and voice: eg poet recalls personal experience as schoolboy or as adult (‘The Toome Road’) the Bog Queen speaks for herself, the Croppy speaks from the grave
- tone: eg the attitude shown towards the subject matter, the attitude towards the reader
- lexical choices, figurative language or other verbal features
- stanza forms, metre, rhyme and other prosodic features.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument, here related to the poetic presentation of place
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.